REPLIFA

BFA Fashion Thesis Collection

LEN YITAI MA

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RepliFa aims to challenge the well-established Eurocentric fashion system. It questions authority at a fundamental level, including the philosophy of the body, the modes of representation, and the historical forces that have subtly shaped the way people understand clothing.

Drawing on more than 8 years of wearing and researching traditional Han Chinese clothing, the designer (Len Ma)’s understanding of authentic Chinese aesthetics goes far beyond clothes. It extends to traditional architecture, pattern, accessories, and their broader ritual contexts. Grounded in rigorous academic knowledge, this understanding forms the foundation of the designer’s practice.

Look 1: the New

Yaoyu in Look 1 "the New"

What's Power?

How do we define Power?

Who defines Power?

How is Power being shown on garments?

Through what structure?

How to redefine Power ?

How does Power help?

Look 1, “the New,” features a round-collared jacket with an extra pair of detachable peak lapel flare guards (摆), a fold-over collared shirt, and a pair of pants.

The jacket is made from a custom-woven 70% wool / 30% silk blend featuring a subtle jacquard pattern of traditional Chinese cloud motifs. It is lined with 100% silk gauze.

The shirt is made from 98% cotton and 2% spandex.

The pants are made from 100% wool.

Look 2: the Trench

Vali in Look 2 "the Trench"

What is Showing off?

How to define Showing off?

Who defines Showing off?

How is Showing off being shown on garments?

Through what structure?

How to redefine?

How does it help?

Look 2, “the Trench,” features an overlapped-collared jacket with a pair of detachable oversized flare guards (摆), a fold-over collared shirt, and a pair of shorts.

The jacket is made from a 100% cotton double-faced satin fabric. It is lined with 100% silk satin with a subtle jacquard pattern featuring cloud motifs.

The shirt is made from 70% cotton and 30% linen.

The shorts are made from 100% wool.

Look 3: the Deconstructed

Yaoyu in Look 3 "the Deconstructed"

What's the most interesting part of Hanfu?

What do I want to show to the audience?

Why is this structure important?

What can I show when I deconstruct this?

How can deconstruction be applied to hanfu?

Look 3, “the Deconstructed,” features a round-collared jacket with a pair of deconstructed flare guards (摆), a fold-over collared shirt, and a pair of asymmetrical-waist pants.

The jacket is made from a 100% wool chalk-striped fabric. It is lined with 100% Silk gauze with a subtle jacquard pattern featuring traditional lotus motifs.

The shirt is made from 98% cotton and 2% spandex.

The pants are made from 100% wool.

Look 4: the Skeleprint

Jiabao in Look 4 "the Skeleprint"

Replica? RepliFa?

Intriguing things created by the passage of time?

A full-scale Replica?

Does it fit into contemporary life?

Is it fashionable?

Look 4, “the Skeleprint,” features a round-collared dress with a pattern and print adapted from a historical garment.

The dress is made from a double-sided twill fabric that is composed of 70% wool and 30% silk. It is lined with a pinstripe fabric composed of 98% cotton and 2% spandex.

Look 5: the Pagoda

Yaoyu in Look 5 "the Pagoda"

Power...?

An enduring and deeply ingrained symbol of Power.

Look 5, “the Pagoda,” features an overlapped-collared jacket with a pair of pagoda sleeve shaped flare guards (摆), a fold-over collared shirt, and a pair of pants with a deconstructed crotch construction.

The jacket is made from 100% cotton.

The shirt is made from 98% cotton and 2% spandex.

The pants are made from 100% wool.

Look 6: the Mix

Vali in Look 6 "the Mix"

Silhouette?

What fabric represents streetwear?

Away to show Hanfu from different dynasties?

Which pieces can be combined to create a streetwear look?

What elements?

Look 6, “the Mix,” features a short round-collared jacket, a round-overlapped collared shirt, a pair of shorts, and a pair of chaps.

The jacket is made from 8.2 oz denim.

The shirt is made from 98% cotton and 2% spandex.

The shorts are made from 100% cotton denim.

The chaps are made from 100% silk gauze.

Look 7: the Old

A minimalist design

Jiabao in Look 7 "the Old"

Look 7, “the Old,” features an overlapped-collared jacket, an overlapped-collared yisa(曳撒), a fold-over collared shirt, and a pair of shorts.

The jacket is made from 100% silk gauze.

The yisa is made from 100% cotton.

The shirt is made from 70% cotton and 30% linen.

The shorts are made from 100% wool.

Look 8: the Felt

Jiabao in Look 8 "the Felt"

The big sleeve is so heavy...

An approach that preserves the original pattern and cut.

An approach that balances tradition and practicality.

An approach that creates a new textile.

Look 8, “the Felt,” features a stand-round collared jacket, a fold-over collared shirt, and a pair of shorts.

The jacket is made from a handmade felted textile incorporating two different wool fabrics: double-sided and single-sided.

The shirt is made from 70% cotton and 30% linen.

The shorts are made from 100% wool.

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